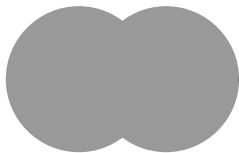


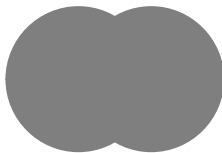
Evolution of Particle Bonding During Sintering

**Initial
Contact**



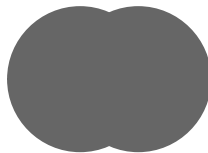
*Point contact
between particles*

**Early
Sintering**



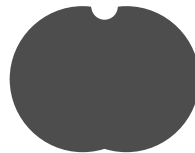
*Neck begins
to form*

**Intermediate
Sintering**



*Neck growth,
pore rounding*

**Final
Sintering**



*Strong bonds,
isolated pores*